

Technology: Software: Detailing the Mosaic: On Cycle to Off Cycle Reads

We aggregate datapoints from the last 3 weeks to refine our views into off-cycle earnings. 2Q26 thus far appears to be the quarter where agentic activity stepped up enough to drive more observable fundamental inflections for companies with the right exposure. We are incrementally positive on **SNOW** (different set up to DDOG, Cortex Code ramp still very early) and **PANW** (uptick in thought leadership into its fiscal year end, specific next-gen acquisitions, exposure to better firewall and observability demand). Conversely, for the first time, we are seeing more meaningful signs of app software risks materializing in results. We believe **CRM** is not immune but may be best positioned in its cohort (most progressed with AELAs and AI monetization models), and are incrementally negative on **ADBE** (SEO to AEO evolution, tool experimentation may impact top of funnel), **INTU** and **WDAY** (potential pressure in the core). We would continue to add to positions in **MSFT**, **SHOP**, **NET** and **TWLO** even post the 2Q moves, as we believe we are the beginning of a multi-quarter fundamental inflection, which is in turn a function of architectural advantages and ongoing engineering innovation.

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1. Agentic activity has picked up. Cloudflare observes agentic traffic to now be over 50% of total web traffic (up from ~20-30% in 2025 and 18m faster than their original projection). Implications:

- ❑ **Developer platforms that work well with agents are seeing an inflection** (e.g by providing opinionated harnesses, edge compute, and more granular billing controls). Cloudflare added nearly 2mn developers in 2Q vs. 1.5mn in all of 2025. Vercel's ARR inflected again in 1H26 after inflecting in Nov 2025 (last disclosed at \$340mn exiting February 2026). Twilio's growth accelerated for the second quarter in a row as AI use cases in Voice continue to ramp.
- ❑ **The long tail of Shopify brands are seeing an outsized benefit** from the specificity of agentic search coupled with Shopify's Catalog product, which sets parameters that code product attributes such that they can be matched with specific agentic searches. Shopify started to observe this trend in 2H25 but saw a much more noticeable uptick in 2Q26.
- ❑ **Software vendors that have outsized exposure to SEO (without an offsetting exposure to AIEO) are seeing a negative impact.** We believe this may partly have impacted HubSpot. EverCommerce (front office tools for micro-vertical businesses) also noted that evolving search behavior

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created headwinds on some organic acquisition and in certain product lines in 1H26.

- **Readacross:** We view this dynamic as an incremental negative for **Adobe** (along with the experimentation dynamic we outline below). We believe Semrush is still in the process of executing its AEO strategy, and it is unclear to us whether LLM conversion for Adobe's top of funnel consumer adds will match its existing SEO top of funnel and given tools like Gemini with in built image generation.

2. SaaS app procurement may be slowing down.

- **Customers are in a phase of experimentation.** It is unclear to us yet whether this is mainly a front office dynamic as the number of new tools layering on top of system of records is high across all categories of apps. This is driving deal cycle elongation and a baseline expectation that tools can be trialed for free, with app software companies absorbing the inference cost.
- **Budget scrutiny is higher.** Recall our May 2026 CIO Survey suggested 33% of enterprise token budget is funded by new allocation, but 66% is from reallocation, with the two biggest categories being labor and app software. **HubSpot** noted a higher pace of core downgrades (in tier and seat count).
- **Figma Make is a good case study of evolving product market fit.** Figma began monetizing its prototyping product, Figma Make, on March 13. Third party data shows MCP connections peaking on May 1 and trending down 25% on June 1. Our understanding is that as customers transitioned to paying for credits, they became more intentional about their spend. Similarly, Figma has several products in beta in 2H but does not have visibility on monetization at this time, as it will likely go through a phase of finding product market fit.
- **Investors have largely disregarded agentic usage improvements that don't quantifiably move the WholeCo needle.** Agent adoption trends included 1) Shopify Sidekick daily active merchants increased 3.6x yoy, daily sessions grew 4.8x and Sidekick handled nearly 34mn conversations. Additionally, merchants created >36,000 custom apps using Sidekick, up from 12,000 in Q1. 2) HubSpot's Data Agent has over 16k customers, up 80% qoq; Prospecting Agent has almost 17k customers, up 28%; and Customer Agent reached over 10,000 customers. 3) Klaviyo added 95k users to Composer Agent in its first month and Customer Agent adoption increased 40% qoq. Only Shopify saw a noticeable change in underlying fundamentals, even though it does not monetize AI directly.
- **Readacross:** We view this as incrementally negative for **Intuit** and **Workday**. **Salesforce** is not immune, but has the best chance of bucking the trend given its ability to bundle AI functionality into AELAs (enterprise licenses that include AI functionality; see our July NDR note [here](#)).

- 3. **New monetization models may require new forecasting tools.** Cloudflare noted that customers on its pool of funds plans (for flexible credit consumption) picked up their pace of consumption in 2Q, which drove its outsized beat. Its growing pool of funds revenue (>20% of NNACV in 4Q25) creates a larger standard deviation of

outcomes in guidance. Rather than providing a larger guidance range, our understanding is Cloudflare is instead discounting the midpoint of its guidance to reflect this new distribution. We expect Cloudflare and other vendors to go through forecasting exercises as more data on new consumption cohorts is available to fine tune guidance. In the meanwhile, beats may be less predictable but also average out to be larger.

- **Readacross: Snowflake** is a consumption business model but is also navigating a new consumption product cycle with Cortex Code, which is discounted in guidance and could also drive a larger beat when the company reports in early September. We believe the set up is different to Datadog, where the bar was particularly high due to imprecise extrapolations from AWS and frontier model ARR trends, as well as unique large customer dynamics. **Microsoft's** Azure beat was partly a factor of the introduction of Github Copilot variable pricing on June 1; we hear that some customers' Github bills tracked up 100% in 2QCY, and as much as 200% for one \$3bn EV software company. This may also positively impact Azure revenue in the September quarter.

4. There is air pocket risk in Security, but any volatility in the high quality names likely gets bought. Thus far, the two reads we have are largely idiosyncratic: **Check Point's** underperformance is a function of a more legacy product and ongoing go to market changes; **Fortinet's** outperformance is a function of its unique cost/performance differentiation in both firewalls and converged networking, and some degree of pull forward before announced pricing hikes. In July, security industry conversations have focused on the new risk from frontier models escaping sandboxes. The immediate next step is for model companies to better harden their sandboxes. The longer-term solve focuses on enterprises using more fulsome AI security tools for defense, and this opportunity likely accrues to the most tech forward platforms: **Palo Alto** and **CrowdStrike**.

- **Readacross:** We expect **PANW** to have the strongest off-cycle Security print given a) potential upside in both firewalls and Chronosphere; b) a step function in intra-quarter thought leadership on X into its fiscal year end. (We believe many industry practitioners look to X to refine their views, and CEO Nikesh Arora has been intentional about posting more frequently); c) targeted next-gen acquisitions that directly address AI risks such as Portkey, Protect and Koi. We are more concerned about air pockets for both **CRWD** (given a high bar into earnings but fundamentals more likely to inflect later in the year) and **OKTA** (which has consistently messaged that agentic identity is likely a CY27 product cycle). We expect any weakness to be bought ahead of a strong 2027. Please see our detailed AI security note from July here: The lag between AI spend and Security AI spend; and when to look for an inflection.

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